

with a slew of recent hirings to drive growth



ARVIND MATHUR, 62
CEO, RAYMOND UCO DENIM

► Joined Raymond in May 2016. IIT, IIM and Harvard alumnus. Leads the denim JV with UCO of Belgium. Has three decades of manufacturing experience, especially with Coats Plc.

“B2B customers are increasingly looking at more of not just fabric, but garmenting as well. So, we are now expanding our garmenting footprint. That has done very well and our whole initiative is to continue that growth”



BALASUBRAMANIAN V., 63
MD, JK FILES & ENGINEERING

► Joined Raymond in October 2017. Brings in vast experience in auto ancillaries, having worked for 25 years at Bosch and Brakes India

“Car production is just at pre-Covid-19 level. With infra development, PLI, etc., there is definitely an opportunity not only in auto but also in the tools and hardware business to grow in healthy double digits”



AMIT AGARWAL, 54
GROUP CFO, RAYMOND

► Joined Raymond in July 2020. Finance whiz with 25 years of work behind him at ArcelorMittal, Essar Steel, Suzlon and Jet Airways

“Earlier our debt structure was skewed towards short-term debt. We have converted them all to long-term debt, and we are sitting with significant cash flows. Our target is to be debt-free in the next three years”

Amit Agarwal, Group CFO of Raymond, looks at the pandemic as a blessing in disguise. “As we grow old, we accumulate a little fat here and a little fat there, and the same thing was happening with the company. We needed to change things,” says Agarwal, 54, smiling broadly with positive energy visible even on a Zoom call. Pointing out that the company cut almost ₹400 crore of operating costs, Agarwal lists a host of measures taken to cut costs, including structural costs such as people, operation, retail stores, ad-

vertising, etc. For example, about 4,000 dealers would get an all-expenses paid annual tour of the company’s Thane plant for trade bookings. That exercise was moved to digital during the pandemic and, even today, is still largely digital.

“We had opened a lot of stores, and in some of them, rental to revenue ratio was as high as 0.6, meaning the rental would be 60 per cent of the revenue. It did not make sense,” he says. So, the company shut about 150 stores where revenues were not picking up. On the people front,

some layers in the organisation were eliminated, and some others were consolidated through the use of technology. Some regional and branch offices were also shut down. “We were able to enhance the productivity levels of our plant operations, and reduce the fabric spoilage, cuts and ends. Every single piece of the business was looked at and improved upon,” says Agarwal.

In addition, the company went hard to bring receivables under control. The net working capital cycle (NWC), at a high 98 days in Septem-